gerstenberg.clinic

2927 Nall Street • Port Neches, Texas 77651 • Phone: 409.210.3336 • Fax: 409.527.3969 • www.gerstenberg.clinic

WELCOME!

We value each of our patients like family and strive for the most professional, compassionate care possible! At gerstenberg.clinic our goal is excellence in all that we do! Please take a moment to familiarize yourself with our practice guidelines and services.

Insurance

We accept most major medical insurance and, of course, we are happy to file your claim for you, electronically, in most cases. We try to be sensitive to each individual's situation in particular needs. Co-pays, coinsurance, and deductibles are part of your agreement with your insurance carrier, and will be collected at the time of service. Due to the rising cost of malpractice insurance, office expenses and so forth, medical expenses continue to skyrocket. We are aware of this and make our best attempt to keep cost down, while providing the most advanced level of care needed. If you receive a bill from our office you do not understand or want to question something, please call the office and do so. We will make every effort to work with financial hardship cases in regard to outstanding account balances.

A $30 charge will occur for returned checks.

Scheduling

We make every effort to ensure timely appointments. Most of the time, we will be able to see you the same day you call. Please reserve this "last minute" type of appointment for just that. For ongoing medical needs, long-term health problems and such, we ask that you please schedule these appointments well ahead of time.

We reserve additional appointment slots in the summer months (June, July and August) for wellness exams/physicals. We do perform annual female exams, men's physicals, adolescent school and camp physicals, so plan to get this done in the summertime. This keeps your exposure to cold and flu minimal.

We try to maximize appointment availability for all of our patients. If, for any reason, you cannot keep your appointment, please call as soon as you realize this, so that we can reschedule for a more convenient time. Any patient arriving more than 15 minutes late to their scheduled appointment time will be rescheduled. A $75-100 charge may occur for any no-show, late arrival, or late cancellation. Please refer to our no-show, late arrival or late cancellation policy for further details. Also, if you have waited more than 15 minutes in the waiting room, please tell the receptionist, as there has probably been an oversight. We are sensitive to your schedule, and hope you'll be sensitive to ours and other patients.

Procedures

We perform many minor procedures you may not be aware of. While many women prefer to go to their OB/GYN for annual check-ups, we are very capable of doing this wellness exam – often a lot sooner than the OB/GYN can! Minor skin bumps, like mole or warts can be treated or removed here in our office. Cancerous or precancerous lesions can usually be addressed right here as well.

Referrals/consultations

If we feel you need to see a specialist, we will make every effort to get you in as soon as possible with them. One of our staff will attempt to get approval from your insurance company (if necessary) and send your request to the specialist's office for an appointment within five business days. Urgent cases will be handled as quickly as possible. Please be patient when referrals take a bit longer! Patients who feel they need a referral to a specialist for a particular illness need to be seen by our provider so that we can make that referral for you. We must have clinical documentation to validate that referral.

Alternative medicine

Dr. Gerstenberg, our providers and staff are interested in getting you the care you need in the safest, most economical way possible. As such, we are always open to those who are interested in alternative therapies. Dr. Gerstenberg is trained in osteopathic manipulation (similar to chiropractic care) and utilizes nutritional approaches to everything from attention deficit/hyperactivity disorder, chronic fatigue, fibromyalgia to irritable bowel syndrome and migraines. Just ask if you are interested.

Prescriptions

The quickest, most effective method for you to have your prescriptions refilled is for you to call your pharmacy to request the refill. Then, your pharmacy will contact us if further action is required. No prescriptions will be refilled if you have not been seen in the office within six months, maximum. Some medications like controlled medications require more frequent office consultations. There will be no narcotic medication refills after hours or on the weekend/holidays. When you call with a question, we will personally address each need.

gerstenberg.clinicWELLNESS

We offer several alternative healthcare options through our Wellness services. This includes vitamins, homeopathic remedies, human-identical hormone therapy, medical weight management options, male ED treatments and more! Look around our clinic and website for materials that detail our Wellness line as we are consistently seeking out ways to diversify and offer the very best NON-drug treatments for our patients and community! Services offered through our Wellness line are considered cash-pay services and claims are not filed with insurance carriers since these Wellness services are not covered by insurance. Some flexible spending accounts (FSA) or health savings accounts (HSA) may reimburse for them and we gladly accept cash, check, credit card and CareCredit for these services.

Tell others if you like the service you get. Tell us if you don't – so we can try to make things right!

Find us on Facebook @gerstenberg.clinic, and on Twitter and Instagram @gdotclinic

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NO-SHOW, LATE ARRIVAL AND LATE CANCELLATION POLICY

Our goal is to provide high quality, individualized medical care in a timely manner. This policy enables us to better utilize available appointments for our patients in need of medical care.

We understand there are times when you must miss a medical appointment due to emergencies. However, missed appointments impact the flow of patient care in our clinic. In order to be respectful of the medical needs of other patients, please be courteous and call us promptly if you are unable to show up for an appointment. This time will be reallocated to someone who is in need of treatment.

Our no-show and cancellation policy applies to missed appointments, which include:

- No-show: You don't arrive for your appointment, and you don't reach out to cancel.
- Late arrival: You arrive 15 or more minutes past your scheduled appointment time.
- Late cancellation: You cancel your appointment less than 1 business day before your scheduled appointment time, this includes reschedules.

Appointments to which you miss (no-show, late arrival, late cancellation) as described above will be subject to a $75 missed appointment fee for the first time, and $100 for any missed visit after. **Note: These fees are not covered by your insurance, are the sole responsibility of the patient and must be paid in full prior to being scheduled for another appointment at the clinic.**

If you have a history of two (2) or more missed appointments with our clinic in a 12-month period, the clinic may decide to dismiss you as a patient. Any unpaid fees will result in a locked account, and you will not be able to make another appointment until it has been paid.

This policy will not apply to missed appointments during a declared weather emergency. We try our best to remain open to our patients, even when others may close, so if you will not be able to make your appointment during a declared weather emergency, please let us know.

You can help us ensure all patients have the appointment access they need by:

- Arriving on time for your appointments.
- Understanding that if you arrive 15 or more minutes after your appointment time, we may need to reschedule your appointment.
- Notifying the clinic at least 1 business day in advance if you can't make it to your appointment. You can notify our clinic of a change or cancellation by phone.

I understand the above No-Show, Late Arrival and Late Cancellation Policy. Any missed appointment fees as described in this policy will be charged to me personally. I understand that I will not be able to schedule an appointment with the clinic until such fees are paid in full.

Printed Patient Name:_____ DOB:_____

Signature:_____ Date:_____
(Patient or Guardian - please state relationship)

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PATIENT INFORMATION SHEET ◆ PLEASE PRINT THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION:

After completing this form, return it along with your **insurance card** and **identification card** to the front desk. Thank you.

Last Name: _____ First: _____ Middle: _____ Date: _____

Birth Sex: ☐ M ☐ F Marital Status: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ W ☐ D SSN: _____ DOB: _____

Race:*** _____ Ethnicity:*** _____ Preferred Language: _____

Street Address: _____ City: _____ State: _____ Zip: _____

Home Phone: _____ Email Address: _____

Cell Phone: _____ Would you like to participate in the patient portal? ☐ Y ☐ N

Work Phone: _____ Patient reminder preference: ☐ Patient Portal ☐ Phone Opt OUT of Email Updates: ☐

Preferred Phone: ☐ H ☐ Cell ☐ W

Current copy of insurance card(s) required. Please provide card(s) to the front desk for a copy to be made.

Guarantor: ☐ Self ☐ Other: _____ DOB: _____ Relationship to Patient: _____ SSN: _____

Is guarantor address same as patient: ☐ Y ☐ Other: _____

Primary Insurance Carrier: _____ If group policy, employer: _____

Member ID: _____ Group number: _____

Secondary Insurance Carrier: _____ If group policy, employer: _____

Member ID: _____ Group number: _____

Employment status: ☐ Employed ☐ Retired ☐ Unemployed Employer: _____

Emergency Contact: First Name: _____ Last Name: _____

Home Phone: _____ Work Phone: _____ Cell Phone: _____ Relationship: _____

Preferred Pharmacy: _____ Location: _____

I am legally able to give consent for treatment, and do affirm consent, for the above patient to receive any type of service deemed medically necessary. I shall be responsible to pay for any professional services received. I realize that insurance billing is performed as a courtesy and is no guarantee of payment for services. I authorize payment to be made directly from the insurance company to the physician and any medical records released to process my claim.

There will be a minimum $25 charge for all requests for medical records other than those requested by other physicians for coordination of care, or as per law.

Estimated co-pays, co-insurance, and/or deductibles are required to be paid at the time of service. A $30 charge will occur for any returned checks. No show, late arrival and late cancellation fees will apply per the clinic's policy. I understand that patients enrolled in a managed care plan (i.e. HMO, POS) must have an office visit to be referred to a specialist. All balances on my account that are 60 days overdue must be resolved before another appointment may be scheduled. Outstanding balances not resolved within 90 days may be reported for collections and will go against my credit report.

I have been provided the opportunity to review the Notice of Privacy Practices of this clinic and have been afforded the opportunity to ask any questions I may have pertaining to the policy. A copy of the clinic's Notice of Privacy Practices may be accessed at any time via www.gerstenberg.clinic. My acknowledgement of these policies will remain in effect until revoked by me in writing. A photocopy of this acknowledgement with my signature is to be considered valid as original.

Signature of Patient or Guarantor: X _____ Date: _____

How did you hear about gerstenberg.clinic? ☐ Word of Mouth ☐ Internet ☐ TV ☐ Newspaper ☐ Other: _____

From the following, what is the main reason you need an appointment? ☐ I need to establish a new primary care doctor/I need a physical

☐ Alternative Options ☐ Fatigue/lack of energy ☐ Anxiety ☐ ADD/ADHD ☐ Diabetes

☐ Knee pain/Knee pain therapy ☐ Hormone issues (describe below) ☐ Depression ☐ Blood pressure ☐ Other (write below)

_____

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*** Race and Ethnicity are required by the US government.

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RELEASE OF BILLING AND MEDICAL INFORMATION

When your family member or friend calls for billing or medical information for you, we need their name listed on file in order to release the information. Please be sure they have your date of birth for reference. If they are unable to verify , we will be unable to release any information over the phone.

Billing/Financial

I give my authorization to release to or discuss billing information with: (Please limit to two individuals)

Name:_____ Name:_____

Relationship:_____ Relationship:_____

Medical

I give my authorization to release to or discuss medical information with: (Please limit to two individuals.
Can be the same as above... if so, write "same".)

Name:_____ Name:_____

Relationship:_____ Relationship:_____

☐ **I do not wish ANYONE to have access to my medical / financial information.**

Printed Patient Name:_____ DOB:_____

Signature:_____ Date:_____
(Patient or Guardian - please state relationship)

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ASSIGNMENT OF BENEFITS AND RELEASE OF PLAN DOCUMENTS AUTHORIZATION

In considering the amount of medical expenses to be incurred, I the undersigned have insurance and/or employee health care benefits coverage. I convey directly to K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. all medical benefits and/or insurance reimbursement, if any, otherwise payable to me for services rendered from this facility. I understand that I am financially responsible for all charges regardless of applicable insurance or benefits payments.

- I hereby authorize K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. to release all medical information necessary to process my claims.
- I authorize any plan administrator or fiduciary, insurer and/or attorney to release to K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. any and all plan documents, insurance policies and/or settlement information upon written request from K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. in order to claim such medical benefits, reimbursement or any applicable remedies.
- I authorize the use of this signature on all of my insurance and/or employee health benefit claim submissions.

I hereby convey to K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. the full extent permissible under the law and under any applicable insurance policies and/or employee healthcare plan, any claim chose in action, or other right I may have to such insurance and/or employee healthcare benefit coverage under any applicable insurance policies and/or employee healthcare plan with respect to medical expenses incurred as a result of the medical services I received from K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. to the extent permissible under the law to claim such medical benefits, insurance reimbursement and any applicable remedies.

Further, in response to any reasonable request for cooperation, I agree to cooperate with K. Paul Gerstenberg, D.O., P.A. in any attempts by this clinic to pursue such claim, chose in action or right against my insurers and/or employee healthcare plan, including, if necessary, to bring suit with the clinic against such insurers and/or employee healthcare plan in my name but at such doctor's expense.

This lifetime assignment will remain in effect until revoked by me in writing. A photocopy of this assignment is to be considered as valid as the original.

I have read and fully understand and consent to this agreement.

Printed Patient Name:_____ DOB:_____

Signature:_____ Date:_____
(Patient or Guardian - please state relationship)

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